

Charlie Grussing-Neitzel

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SUMMARY

Technology leader skilled at aligning engineering strategy with business objectives to drive operational excellence, innovation, and sustainable growth. Known for building cohesive, high-performing teams where collaboration, trust, and continuous learning are core to the culture. Accomplished in transforming engineering operations to improve productivity, streamline deployment cycles, and create scalable processes that teams embrace. Recognized for a leadership style that values transparency, feedback, and work-life balance—empowering teams to deliver results with consistency, creativity, and sustained excellence.

SKILLS

- **Soft Skills:** Growth Mindset, Organized, Communication, Activator, Positivity, Fun, Devoted, Forward Thinker, CI/CD, Infrastructure as Code, Full Stack Development, React, AWS

TESTIMONIALS (from peers, direct reports, and supervisors)

- “A true curator of culture — Charlie has built processes that keep the team aligned, motivated, and delivering at a high level.”
- “The difference before Charlie and now is palpable — developers trust the process, collaborate more, and morale is higher than ever.”
- “Processes are clear, consistent, and embraced by the team — the cadence of impactful releases speaks for itself.”
- “Charlie puts the team first, valuing work-life balance, transparency, and feedback while driving delivery excellence.”
- “The maturity of our CI/CD and automation processes is remarkable for a company this size — a direct result of Charlie’s leadership.”
- “Charlie’s technical expertise, coupled with his excellent communication skills, made him an indispensable asset to our team. His ability to bridge the gap between technical complexities and team objectives was truly commendable.”
- Charlie is very thorough and detail oriented developer and leader. He brings nothing but positive energy to a team and thoughtful leadership.”

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SmartThings

Mar 2024 - Jul 2025

Manager, Engineering – Device Core

Minneapolis, MN

- Directed cross-functional initiatives by providing clear leadership and strategic collaboration, aligning engineering efforts with business priorities, resulting in improved project outcomes
- Owned and prioritized the Device Core (DC) Team roadmap to effectively balance engineering capacity with stakeholder business goals.
- Provided hands-on leadership through regular 1:1s, performance reviews, and growth plans, fostering a growth mindset among team members.
- Collaborated on initiatives to enhance the resiliency, scalability, and stability of DC services, achieving measurable improvements in reliability.
- Led infrastructure cost analysis and implemented cost-reduction strategies to drive operational efficiency.
- Recruited and hired top engineering talent while promoting internal high-performers, reinforcing team development and retention.
- Revamped team processes to focus on outcomes, including introducing Agile Scrum practices within the DC Team.
- Enhanced roadmap transparency by restructuring planning artifacts, thus improving stakeholder visibility and strategic alignment.
- Established team velocity tracking and forecasting to enable accurate delivery timelines and to support capacity planning.
- Cultivated a collaborative and inclusive team culture through active peer feedback, shared design ownership, and effective communication.
- Co-led the restructuring of device space engineering teams in partnership with senior leadership, reinforcing alignment with business needs.
- Represented team initiatives in cross-functional discussions as a culture ambassador, contributing to company-wide strategy and engagement.
- Refined team operations and engineering standards, leading to increased productivity and technical excellence

PARKCHIRP

Mar 2023 - Nov 2023

Chief Technology Officer

Chicago, IL

- Overhauled engineering operations by instituting agile development practices, unified code flow pipelines, and streamlined Jira workflows to better align technical execution with strategic business goals.
- Enhanced operational efficiency, with engineer’s time on task increasing by 57% and production deployments advancing to multiple daily deploys.
- Instituted end-to-end automated testing and integrated quality engineers into development teams, ensuring fast feedback loops and

zero production reverts.

- Facilitated SOC 2 compliance through vendor selection, precise requirement gathering, and project oversight, strengthening security and stakeholder confidence.
- Recruited 15 engineers and reduced overall labor expenses by 43% by transitioning to an internal FTE model, supporting scalable growth.
- Translated roadmap features into clear BDD with Gherkin writeups and detailed requirements, aligning cross-functional teams on project objectives.
- Optimized development workflows by creating quick scripts and aliases that decreased time managing branches and merge conflicts by 18%.
- Mentored technical staff on development practices while cultivating clear growth paths and aligning team efforts with evolving business priorities.
- Collaborated with executive leadership to address team wellbeing, reduce burnout, and ensure strategic prioritization of milestones.
- Contributed to high-priority full stack features, balancing rapid delivery with maintaining technical excellence, which enhanced product quality and delivery speed

PARKCHIRP

Sep 2022 - Mar 2023

Principal Software Engineer

Chicago, IL

- Contributed as a full stack engineer to a microservice SaaS platform using React, GraphQL, Node.js, and MySQL in AWS Cloud Services (Lambda, Cognito, EC2, DynamoDB, etc.), ensuring technical excellence and reliability.
- Built and delivered technically complex serverless services, reinforcing cross-team integration and operational efficiency.
- Led the full rebuild of the platform stack with React 18, Next.js, and a revamped API v2 using GraphQL, ensuring alignment with current technical best practices.
- Introduced robust coding standards and streamlined project repository taxonomy to promote maintainability and clarity across development teams.

EXOSITE

Sep 2018 - Jul 2022

Director of Software Delivery

Minneapolis, MN

- Identified and rectified inefficiencies in Jenkins build and delivery pipelines, reducing average deployment time from 1.5 hours to under minutes and boosting team velocity by 34% year over year.
- Enhanced infrastructure monitoring and reduced monthly cloud expenses from over \$200k to under \$50k without impacting end user experience or platform performance.
- Addressed performance bottlenecks by spearheading performance and scalability testing, streamlining data flow and API interactions across services.
- Oversaw and collaborate daily with multicultural engineering teams (Devs, DevOps, QA) across US, Czech, Hungary, Taiwan, and Brazil, fostering a culture of clear communication and strategic mentorship.
- Conducted regular 1-on-1 mentoring, annual 360° reviews, and skill development support for individual contributors and emerging leaders, driving team growth.
- Boosted team morale and ensured zero attrition over 3.5 years by organizing innovative initiatives like hackathons, bug squashing events, and social hours, resulting in an engaged and productive team.
- Managed a partial company sell-off by reducing the workforce by 67% while maintaining 99.9% platform uptime and consistent delivery of client features.

Exosite – **Senior Front End Developer, Tech Lead**

2017 – 2018

GN Services – **Owner, UI/UX Designer, Full Stack developer**

2004 – 2019

TIES – **Senior Lead Software Developer – edSpring**

2013 – 2017

Merrill Corporation – **Web Developer**

2010 – 2013

Analysts International Corporation (AIC) – **Web Application Developer**

2009 – 2010

Inetium – **SharePoint Designer, UI Developer**

2008 – 2009

University of Minnesota - Center for Transportation Studies – **Web Coordinator**

2005 – 2008

Osseo Area Schools – **District Webmaster**

2001 – 2005

EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin-Stout

Bachelor's Degree, Technology Education w/ emphasis in Telecommunications